

more worthy of credence than the bullish propaganda which is widely circulated at the peak of a market movement.

## EACH TO HIS OWN DECISION

No one ever attained a fortune by seeking the advice of others. This is the basis for the eighth rule. An efficiency expert may point the way to technical improvements in the conduct of a business, but he can do no more. The responsibility for the success or failure of the business must rest in the final analysis on the energy, character, ability and force of decision of one man. The Fords, Rockefellers, Morgans have not dominated their chosen fields by seeking the advice of "experts," but by following their own judgment, though it may have meant on occasion flying in the face of precedent.

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*Vanity plays a great part in the willingness with which traders fall victim to supposed "straight tips" . . . To be the recipient of such confidential information sets him apart from the ignorant herd . . .*

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The venerable Chauncey M. Depew once gave an interview to an inquiring reporter who wanted to know what had been the greatest mistakes of his life. In reply Mr. Depew detailed three. Financially his greatest error was his failure to purchase a sixth interest in the infant which later became the American Telephone & Telegraph Co. for \$10,000. Strongly attracted to the venture Mr. Depew yet deferred action until he had consulted expert advice. To this end he approached a personal friend, the president of the Western Union Telegraph Co., doubtless the best qualified expert available to anyone. In all sincerity he was told that the tele-